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THE KING'S LODGE

Discovering the Psalms

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Part 5

Introduction to the Book of Psalms

The Use of the Psalms in Israel's Worship

- David was a skilled musician: 1 Sam 16:18
- He introduced music into the temple worship, 1 Chron 15:16ff, v22, v27 and 16:4 - 7 and 37 - 43

The Use of the Psalms in Israel's Worship

- David the Poet:
- David's lament over Saul and Jonathan 2 Sam 1:19ff
- David's song of thanksgiving. 2 Sam 22, repeated in Psalms 18
- Many Psalms of David

The Title of some Psalms

- Complete title in Ps 60 only:
- ‘To the leader: according to the Lily of the Covenant. A Miktam of David; for instruction; when he struggled with Aram- naharaim and with Aram-zobah, and when Joab on his return killed twelve thousand Edomites in the Valley of Salt’

The Title of some Psalms

- Complete title in Ps 60 only:
- To the Leader: Assignment (choir director?)
- According to Lily of the Covenant: Music
- A Miktam: Literary type (psalm, maskil, song etc)
- Of David: by, to, for or about David
- For instruction: Purpose
- When he struggled etc.: Occasion (2 Sam 8:13)

The Occasion of the Psalms

- 13 psalms have the occasion stated, all are events in the life of David: 3, 18, 30, 34, 51, 52, 54, 56, 57, 59, 60, 63, 142
- For others, the occasion can be pieced together from the content

Structure of the Psalms

The Division of the Book of Psalms

- The book of Psalms is divided into 5 distinct books
- Book I 1-41
- Book II 42-72
- Book III 73-89
- Book IV 90-106
- Book V 107-150

Repeated Psalms

- Ps 14 cf. Ps 53
- Ps 15 cf. Ps 24:3-6
- Ps 40:13-17 cf. Ps 70
- Ps 57:7-11 cf. Ps 108:1-5
- Ps 60:5-12 cf. Ps 108:6-13

Each Book Ends With a Doxology

- Book I 41:13
- Blessed be the Lord, the God of Israel,
- from everlasting to everlasting.
- Amen and Amen

Each Book Ends With a Doxology

- Book II 72:18-20
- Blessed be the Lord, the God of Israel,
- who alone does wondrous things.
- Blessed be his glorious name forever;
- may his glory fill the whole earth.
- Amen and Amen.
- The prayers of David son of Jesse are ended

Each Book Ends With a Doxology

- Book III 89:52
- Blessed be the Lord forever.
- Amen and Amen

Each Book Ends With a Doxology

- Book IV 106:48
- Blessed be the Lord, the God of Israel,
- from everlasting to everlasting.
- And let all the people say, “Amen.”
- Praise the Lord

Each Book Ends With a Doxology

- Book V 150 complete psalm
- Praise the Lord!
- Praise God in his sanctuary…
- …Let everything that breathes praise the Lord!
- Praise the Lord

Some Psalms Form One Psalm in the Original

- 9 & 10: Partial alphabetic acrostic
- 42 & 43: The refrain is repeated

"Why are you cast down, O my soul,
and why are you in turmoil within me?
Hope in God; for I shall again praise him,
my salvation and my God" (ESV)

The Classifications Or Categories of Psalms

Some Classifications of the Psalms

- Psalms of Lament i.e. 3, 5
- Psalms of Thanksgiving i.e. 34, 65
- Hymns of Praise i.e. 8, 19
- Wisdom i.e. 1, 37
- Salvation History Psalms i.e. 78, 105

Some Classifications of the Psalms

- Songs of Trust i.e. 11, 16
- Royal Psalms i.e. 2, 3
- Liturgies i.e. 15, 24
- Songs of Zion i.e. 46, 48
- Imprecatory Psalms i.e. 28:4, 31:17-18
- Post-exilic Psalms i.e. 126?, 137

Some Groupings of the Psalms

- The Egyptian Hallel (Praise) - Ps 113-118
- The Great Hallel - Ps 120-136
- The Final Hallel - Ps146-150
- Songs of Ascent - 120-134

Two main Classifications of the psalms

- Laments and praise
- Far more laments than praise
- Progression from lament to praise throughout the whole book of Psalms